Yujin Kwon

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Education

Ph.D., Economics, The University of Texas at Austin *2027 (Anticipated)*

M.A., Economics, Ewha Womans University, South Korea *2021*

B.A., Economics, Ewha Womans University, South Korea *2019*

Teaching and Research Fields

Fields: Econometrics, Applied Econometrics, Economics of Education

References

Brendan Kline (Chair)
Department of Economics
The University of Texas at Austin
Email: brendan.kline@utexas.edu

Jason Abrevaya
Department of Economics
The University of Texas at Austin
Email: abrevaya@austin.utexas.edu

Xinyue Bei
Department of Economics
The University of Texas at Austin
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Lauren Schudde
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The University of Texas at Austin
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Job Market Paper

Kwon, Y. Identification and Estimation of Generalized Selection Models, with an Application to Texas Direct

This paper studies models in which the observability of people's outcomes depends on their economic choices. In these models, the outcomes resulting from a given treatment are observed only for those who chose to participate in that treatment through a rational decision-making process. By relaxing some of the identifying restrictions commonly leveraged by existing tools, the proposed method enables identification and estimation of general models with choice-dependent outcomes. The generality of our method allows it to be applied even when data limitations, such as limited or censored instrumental variables, preclude researchers from fully determining how people's decisions affect the observability of their outcomes. The proposed procedures provide a simple framework for studying counterfactual choice-specific outcomes for the population in a way that reflects the available information. They are applied to evaluate the effect of Texas Direct, a major community college transfer initiative. Using Texas administrative data, I find that although completing the Texas Direct curricula component can increase students' chances of earning a four-year degree, the smaller contribution of pre-transfer credits to degree attainment among curriculum completers, relative to students who complete neither curriculum, can mute the policy's positive effects.

Publications

Ryu, W., Kwon, Y., & Schudde, L. T. Developmental education reform and student outcomes at California community colleges: The role of transfer-level course enrollment. *AERA Open*. Forthcoming.

Schudde, L., Callahan, R., Kwon, Y., & Pack-Cosme, K. (2025). Variation in English learners' programmatic experiences and postsecondary trajectories. *Educational Policy*. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1177/08959048251395201

Schudde, L. T., Callahan, R. M., & Kwon, Y. (2025). Language and postsecondary trajectories: How "ever-English learner" status predicts college outcomes. *Review of Higher Education, 48*(3), 445–476. https://doi.org/10.1353/rhe.2025.a954242

Working Papers

Kwon, Y. Two-sample two-stage least squares estimation of nonparametric models. Revised and resubmitted at *Journal of Econometrics*.

Kwon, Y., Schudde, L. T., & Ryu, W. Expanding access, advancing outcomes: Evidence from California's developmental education reform. Recommended for publication pending minor revisions at *Educational Policy*.
Working paper can be accessed at: https://ssrn.com/abstract=5412955

von Hippel, P. T., Hogan, E. K., Kwon, Y., et al. Genesis of the Mississippi Miracle: State Reading Reforms and K-3 Reading Skills, 2013-2019. Submitted to *Journal of Educational Psychology*.

Works in Progress

Bhatt, T. R. & Kwon, Y. Single-Crossing, Information Ordering, and Identification in Choice under Uncertainty.

von Hippel, P. T., He, Z., Kwon, Y., et al. Gaming the NAEP? Do State Reading Policies Increase Learning, or Just Change Who Takes the Test?

Honors, Awards, and Fellowships

University Graduate Continuing Fellowship, The University of Texas at Austin (2025–2026)

Graduate School Continuing Fellowship, The University of Texas at Austin (2022)

College Recruitment Fellowship, The University of Texas at Austin (2021)

2nd Place, Korean Labor & Income Panel Study Graduate Student Paper Contest (2020)

Alternate Candidate, Fulbright Korea Graduate Program (2020)

3rd Place, Korea Employment Information Service Survey Graduate Student Paper Contest (2020)

Research Grant, Ewha Womans University (2018)

Honors Scholarship, Ewha Womans University (2016, 2018)

Research

Guidance, Tools, & Field Education for Dual Enrollment Equity Pathways. Aug 2026 – Present. Department of Economics, Teachers College. Research Assistant to Prof. Lauren Schudde.

Understanding Students' Pursuit and Attainment of STEM Degrees/The Effects of Core Curriculum Completion on Community College Students. Mar 2025 – Present. Department of Economics, The University of Texas at Austin. Researcher at the Texas Education Research Center.

The Implementation, Impact, and Cost-Effectiveness of Developmental Education Curricular Reform in California Community Colleges. Jan 2024 – Jul 2025. Institute of Education Sciences. Research Assistant to Prof. Lauren Schudde.

A Mississippi Miracle? The Effect of Science of Reading Policies on Elementary Reading Skills. Aug 2023 – May 2024. Smith Richardson Foundation. Research Assistant to Prof. Paul von Hippel.

English Learner Status and Postsecondary Outcomes: Exploring Patterns and Policy Levers to Close Gaps. Jan 2022 – Dec 2023. Greater Texas Foundation. Research Assistant to Prof. Lauren Schudde and Rebecca Callahan.

Tax Analysis Project. Ewha Womans University. 2020 – 2021. Research Assistant to Prof. Hosin Song.

Teaching

Teaching Assistant, Econometrics (Ph.D. course), The University of Texas at Austin (Fall 2024, Spring 2024)

Teaching Assistant, Intro to Microeconomics (undergraduate course), The University of Texas at Austin (Fall 2021)

Teaching Assistant, Financial Economics (undergraduate course), Ewha Womans University (2020–2021)

Teaching Assistant, Statistics for Economics (undergraduate course), Ewha Womans University (2020–2021)

Teaching Assistant, Financial Econometrics, Ewha Womans University (2020)

Conference Presentations

Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (2024)

Midwest Econometrics Group Conference (2024)

Texas Camp Econometrics (2024, 2026)

Workshops

Price Theory Summer Camp, The University of Chicago (2024)

CSWEP Mentoring Workshop (2023)

Skills

Languages: English, Korean

Software: Python, Stata, MATLAB, SLURM/HPC environment